

The template for the Advanced News page iterates over the "news" list in the context, rendering a table. Each item of news is a tuple, with the first item in the tuple being the date and the second being the headline. The `{% cycle %}` tag cycles through the values inside of it for each iteration a loop, in this example changing the background color of the table row from a darker to lighter grey. The `| date` filter is similar to the `strftime()` function in Python, formatting a date object for display. The whole template for the Advanced News page is shown in the following listing.

Listing E.11 The template for rendering the Advanced News page

```
<!-- RiffMates/templates/adv_news.html -->
{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block title %}
    {{block.super}}: News
{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
    <h1>RiffMates Advanced News</h1>

    <table>
        {% for item in news %}
            <tr style="background-color:
                {% cycle '#ddd' '#bbb' %}">
                <td> {{ item.0 | date:"Y-m-d" }} </td>
                <td> {{ item.1 }} </td>
            </tr>
        {% endfor %}
    </table>

{% endblock content %}
```

Iterate over the value of "news" in the context dictionary.

The `{% cycle %}` returns the next value in its sequence each time the loop is executed.

Use the `| date` filter to format the date in year-month-day format.

Put the news headline in the second column in the row.

E.3 Chapter 4

Django's ORM allows you to use a database without writing any SQL. Chapter 4 introduced you to writing `Model` classes, running queries, and accessing parts of a table at a time through pagination.

Exercise 1

Modify the `musicians` index view to take an additional query parameter that specifies the number of objects per page. Make sure to support reasonable default and maximum values.

The `Paginator` class takes the number of items per page in its constructor. Prior to this exercise, this value was hardcoded. All three exercises in this chapter use a `Paginator`, so in addition to adding a query parameter specifying the number of items per page, the bounds checking on this query parameter and the page number query